BUILT WITH SCIENCE™
6-WEEK
CHEST GROWTH
WORKOUT PLAN

TABLE OF CONTENTS

OVERVIEW 3

WEEKS 1-2

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1 5
DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1 6
DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2 7
DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2 8

SHORTCUT YOUR TRANSFORMATION 9

WEEKS 3-4

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1 11
DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1 12
DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2 13
DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2 14

WEEKS 5-6

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1 16
DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1 17
DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2 18
DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2 19

EXERCISE TUTORIALS

BARBELL BACK SQUAT 21
BARBELL DEADLIFT 22
BEHIND BODY CABLE CURLS 23
BIRD DOG 24
DUMBBELL CHEST SUPPORTED ROW (MID/UPPER BACK FOCUSED) 25
DUMBBELL LATERAL RAISES 26
DUMBBELL ROMANIAN DEADLIFT 27
FRONT FOOT ELEVATED REVERSE LUNGES 28
LOW INCLINE DUMBBELL PRESS 29
PALLOFF PRESS 30
PULL-UPS 31
SEATED CABLE ROW (MID/UPPER BACK FOCUSED) 32
SEATED LEG CURLS 33
SEATED LEG EXTENSIONS 34
SEATED MID-CHEST CABLE FLYES 35
SEATED WEIGHTED CALF RAISES 36
STANDING BARBELL OVERHEAD PRESS 37
STANDING FACE PULLS 38
STANDING WEIGHTED CALF RAISES (BARBELL OR DUMBBELL) 39

EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES

UPPER BODY 1 41
UPPER BODY 2 42
LOWER BODY 1 43
LOWER BODY 2 44

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS 45
DISCLAIMER 46

OVERVIEW

Welcome to your 6-week chest plan!

This plan uses the following 4-day workout split:

MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
Upper Body 1	Lower Body 1	*Rest*	Upper Body 2	Lower Body 2	*Rest*	*Rest*

The exact days of each workout don't matter. The key is that you are getting at least 3 rest days per week so that you are not doing more than 2 workout days in a row. Your rest days should ideally be set up like the example above, after every "lower body" workout.

This workout routine is set up for 6 weeks that will focus primarily on optimizing chest growth by not only incorporating the 2 main chest growth exercises, but also increasing your weekly chest volume from 10 sets to 18 sets by the last training block.

After you complete the 6 weeks, we recommend joining one of our ***Built With Science programs*** for more science-based workouts to continue challenging you and getting you results.

BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

WEEKS 1-2

WEEKLY CHEST VOLUME 10

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	3	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 15 degrees up (1 notch up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	2	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Pull-Ups	3	6-12	2-3 min	Grip outside shoulder-width, pull until chin over bar, use alternative if unable to do 6 reps in a row.
Dumbbell Lateral Raises	3	15-20	1.5-2 min	Lean torso forward slightly, raise arms in scapular plane, avoid using momentum.
Dumbbell Chest Supported Row (mid/ upper back focused)	3	10-12	1.5-2 min	Set bench 2 notches up from bottom, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder blades together.

DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Back Squat	3	8-10	2-3 min	Experiment with foot stance, squat down to at least parallel, elevate heels onto weight plates if needed.
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	3	10-12	2 min	Push hips back, slight bend in knees, lower until hands reach level of shins.
Seated Leg Extensions	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Pull down on handles, pause at top position, control weight down.
Standing Weighted Calf Raises (barbell or dumbbell)	3	10-15	1.5 min	Feet hip width apart, elevate toes on weight plate, press up on big toes.
Palloff Press	2	5 per side	1 min	Use cables or band, press arms straight out and back in.

DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	3	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 30 degrees up (2 notches up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	2	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Seated Cable Row (mid/ upper back focused)	3	8-10	1.5-2 min	Use wide grip handle if possible, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder-blades together.
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	3	6-8	2-3 min	Press in straight line up, keep core and glutes engaged, avoid arching back.
Behind Body Cable Curls	3	10-12	1.5-2 min	Take small step forward from cable, let arm hang behind you, curl cable up.
Standing Face Pulls	3	10	1 min	Use double rope attachment if possible, use light weight, perform without Y-raise to make it easier.

DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Deadlift	3	6-8	2-3 min	Hip-width stance, grip outside knees, keep head/back/hips in straight line.
Front Foot Elevated Reverse Lunges	3	8-10 per leg	2 min	Stand on weight plate, take long step backward, lean torso forward slightly, alternate legs each rep.
Seated Leg Curls	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Keep toes pointed straight up, control the weight, avoid arching lower back.
Seated Weighted Calf Raise	3	10-15	1.5 min	Point toes forward, lower heels as far as possible, push up on big toes.
Bird Dog	2	5 per side	1 min	Straighten opposite arm/leg, avoid arching low back.

SHORTCUT YOUR TRANSFORMATION

GET 25% OFF A CUSTOM MEAL PLAN FOR CHEST GROWTH!

Proper nutrition will be responsible for at least 80% of the muscle growth you experience. You can do these chest workouts all you want, but they won't grow if you're not adequately fueling your body with the proper amount of food.

If you want an expert to take care of the guesswork for you and create a diet plan designed to maximize your muscle growth then...

CLICK HERE TO ORDER YOUR CUSTOM MEAL PLAN TODAY

Each meal plan is made by a Registered Dietitian and tailored to your specific body and lifestyle. You can use the code CHESTDIET at checkout for 25% off (limited time only).

BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

WEEKS 3-4

WEEKLY CHEST VOLUME 14

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	4	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 15 degrees up (1 notch up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Pull-Ups	3	6-12	2-3 min	Grip outside shoulder-width, pull until chin over bar, use alternative if unable to do 6 reps in a row.
Dumbbell Lateral Raises	3	15-20	1.5-2 min	Lean torso forward slightly, raise arms in scapular plane, avoid using momentum.
Dumbbell Chest Supported Row (mid/ upper back focused)	3	10-12	1.5-2 min	Set bench 2 notches up from bottom, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder blades together.

DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Back Squat	3	8-10	2-3 min	Experiment with foot stance, squat down to at least parallel, elevate heels onto weight plates if needed.
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	3	10-12	2 min	Push hips back, slight bend in knees, lower until hands reach level of shins.
Seated Leg Extensions	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Pull down on handles, pause at top position, control weight down.
Standing Weighted Calf Raises (barbell or dumbbell)	3	10-15	1.5 min	Feet hip width apart, elevate toes on weight plate, press up on big toes.
Palloff Press	2	5 per side	1 min	Use cables or band, press arms straight out and back in.

DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	4	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 30 degrees up (2 notches up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Seated Cable Row (mid/ upper back focused)	3	8-10	1.5-2 min	Use wide grip handle if possible, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder-blades together.
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	3	6-8	2-3 min	Press in straight line up, keep core and glutes engaged, avoid arching back.
Behind Body Cable Curls	3	10-12	1.5-2 min	Take small step forward from cable, let arm hang behind you, curl cable up.
Standing Face Pulls	3	10	1 min	Use double rope attachment if possible, use light weight, perform without Y-raise to make it easier.

DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Deadlift	3	6-8	2-3 min	Hip-width stance, grip outside knees, keep head/back/hips in straight line.
Front Foot Elevated Reverse Lunges	3	8-10 per leg	2 min	Stand on weight plate, take long step backward, lean torso forward slightly, alternate legs each rep.
Seated Leg Curls	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Keep toes pointed straight up, control the weight, avoid arching lower back.
Seated Weighted Calf Raise	3	10-15	1.5 min	Point toes forward, lower heels as far as possible, push up on big toes.
Bird Dog	2	5 per side	1 min	Straighten opposite arm/leg, avoid arching low back.

BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

WEEKS 5-6

WEEKLY CHEST VOLUME 18

DAY 1: UPPER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	5	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 15 degrees up (1 notch up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	4	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Pull-Ups	2	6-12	2-3 min	Grip outside shoulder-width, pull until chin over bar, use alternative if unable to do 6 reps in a row.
Dumbbell Lateral Raises	2	15-20	1.5-2 min	Lean torso forward slightly, raise arms in scapular plane, avoid using momentum.
Dumbbell Chest Supported Row (mid/ upper back focused)	2	10-12	1.5-2 min	Set bench 2 notches up from bottom, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder blades together.

DAY 2: LOWER BODY 1

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Back Squat	3	8-10	2-3 min	Experiment with foot stance, squat down to at least parallel, elevate heels onto weight plates if needed.
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	3	10-12	2 min	Push hips back, slight bend in knees, lower until hands reach level of shins.
Seated Leg Extensions	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Pull down on handles, pause at top position, control weight down.
Standing Weighted Calf Raises (barbell or dumbbell)	3	10-15	1.5 min	Feet hip width apart, elevate toes on weight plate, press up on big toes.
Palloff Press	2	5 per side	1 min	Use cables or band, press arms straight out and back in.

DAY 3: UPPER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Low Incline Dumbbell Press	5	8-12	2-3 min	Set bench to 30 degrees up (2 notches up from the bottom), keep chest up, avoid flaring elbows out.
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	4	10-15	1.5-2 min	Set cables to shoulder height, place half or full foam roller behind back, scoot butt forward on bench, squeeze arms together, pause at end position.
Seated Cable Row (mid/ upper back focused)	2	8-10	1.5-2 min	Use wide grip handle if possible, angle elbows out, squeeze shoulder-blades together.
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	2	6-8	2-3 min	Press in straight line up, keep core and glutes engaged, avoid arching back.
Behind Body Cable Curls	2	10-12	1.5-2 min	Take small step forward from cable, let arm hang behind you, curl cable up.
Standing Face Pulls	2	10	1 min	Use double rope attachment if possible, use light weight, perform without Y-raise to make it easier.

DAY 4: LOWER BODY 2

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (MIN)	NOTES
Barbell Deadlift	3	6-8	2-3 min	Hip-width stance, grip outside knees, keep head/back/hips in straight line.
Front Foot Elevated Reverse Lunges	3	8-10 per leg	2 min	Stand on weight plate, take long step backward, lean torso forward slightly, alternate legs each rep.
Seated Leg Curls	3	10-15	1.5-2 min	Keep toes pointed straight up, control the weight, avoid arching lower back.
Seated Weighted Calf Raise	3	10-15	1.5 min	Point toes forward, lower heels as far as possible, push up on big toes.
Bird Dog	2	5 per side	1 min	Straighten opposite arm/leg, avoid arching low back.

BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

EXERCISE TUTORIALS

BARBELL BACK SQUAT

ATTENTION: For the barbell back squat, since the exercise is quite technical, it is recommended that you ***watch the full exercise tutorial video***. If needed, perform the exercise regression included in the video first if needed before performing the full barbell back squat.

STEP 1: SETUP

Set a barbell in a rack at about the height of your mid-chest. Face the bar and grip it with your hands slightly wider than shoulder-width apart. Duck under the bar and place it over the back of your shoulders, letting it rest on your upper traps. Lift it out of the rack by extending your legs. Take one step back with one foot, one step back with the other one, and then use a third step to correct your stance into an even position. The optimal foot stance will vary, but first experiment with a stance that is just outside shoulder-width with your toes pointed outwards at about 15 degree angle.

STEP 2

Plant your feet firmly into the ground, pull the bar down into your upper back, and engage your core. Take a deep breath in through your nose, and then squat straight down by bending at your hips and knees. As you do so, the bar should remain over the level of your midfoot and the weight should be evenly distributed between your big toe, your little toe, and your heels. Your knees should also be bending slightly outwards in the same direction of your toes. Continue squatting down until your thighs reach at least parallel or slightly below. From here, while keeping your core engaged, exhale and reverse the movement by extending your legs, thinking about bringing the bar up towards the ceiling and exhaling as you do so.

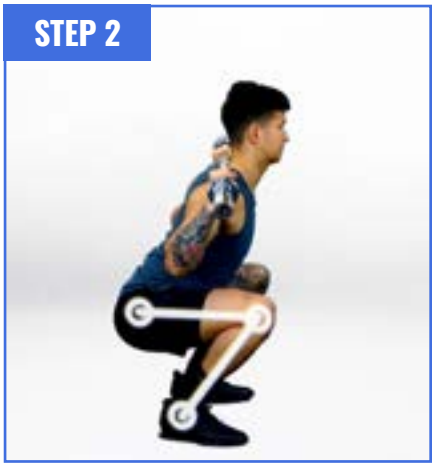
When done correctly, the bar should make an almost perfectly vertical path down and up each rep. Depending on your anatomy, your torso may end up more vertical or more bent over than others, which is normal as long as you're following the tips and avoiding the common mistakes.

ADDITIONAL TIPS: If you find it difficult to reach full depth, you can try elevating your heels onto weight plates to help with ankle mobility.

STEP 1

STEP 1

STEP 2



STEP 2

BARBELL DEADLIFT

For the barbell deadlift, since the exercise is quite technical, it is recommended that you *watch the exercise tutorial video*.

STEP 1: SETUP

We're going to cover the conventional deadlift, which involves a fairly narrow stance.

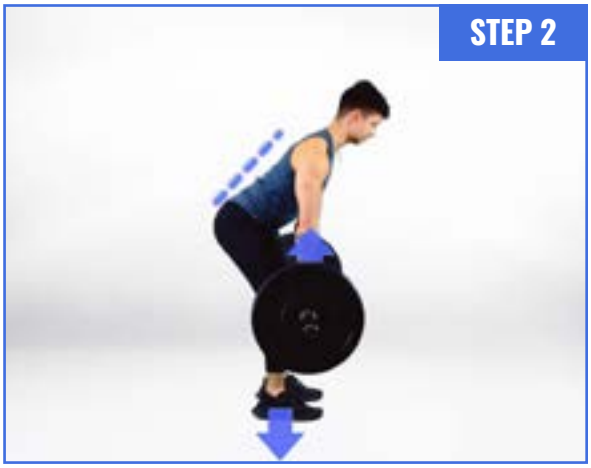
Start with a barbell on the ground. If you have access to big bumper plates, load the bar with those. If you aren't going to be using any weight or only have access to smaller weight plates, either elevate the bar onto a rack, weight stack, or any elevated platform so that the bar starts at about the level of your shins.

Stand under the bar with your feet about hip-width apart and toes pointed outwards slightly. When you look down at the bar, it should be directly over your midfoot. Get down to grip the bar by pushing your hips back with a slight bend in your knees. Keep your back straight as you do so, and continue lowering until you're able to reach the bar. With your arms straight, grip the bar with an overhand grip that's about shoulder-width apart, which should be just outside of your knees. Bring the bar as close to your shins as possible and tuck your chin down to align your neck with your spine by gazing at the floor just a few feet in front of you.

STEP 2

Stabilize your body by thinking about bending the bar in half towards you by engaging your lat muscles, and then pull your chest up and hips down to wedge yourself into the bar. From here, brace your core and pull the slack out of the bar by lightly pulling up against it and pushing your feet away from the floor.

From here, while maintaining a straight back and keeping your chest up, pull up on the bar while pushing your feet down against the floor. As you do so, the bar should travel in a perfectly straight line up over your midfoot and should be kept as close to your body as possible. Once the weight passes your knees, drive your hips forward and squeeze your glutes to finish the lift. From here, control the weight back down by first pushing your hips back and then once the weight passes your knees, bending your knees until the weights touch the ground. Again, keep the bar as close to your thighs and knees as possible as you do so. You can choose to either perform touch and go reps, just lightly tapping the ground with the weights each rep, or you can choose to let the weights fully settle on the ground and reset your form before going into the next rep.



ADDITIONAL TIPS

If you still have trouble with rounding your back as you pull, try lightening the weight and also consider elevating the starting position onto weight plates to shorten the range of motion. This is especially helpful for taller individuals or those with certain hip structures that make getting into the deadlift position difficult. You don't need to lift from the floor unless you're planning to compete as a powerlifter.

BEHIND BODY CABLE CURLS

STEP 1: SETUP

Attach a handle to each cable and move it to the lowest position. Face away from the cable and grab the handle in each arm. Take a couple small steps forward and let your arms hang straight slightly behind your body and towards the direction of the cable.

STEP 2

Brace your core, pull your shoulders down and away from your ears, and then while keeping your elbows locked in position, curl your hands up towards your shoulders. As you do so, you should be curling up but also slightly inward to match the direction of the cable. Once your arms reach roughly the level of your chest, control the weight back down until your arms fully straighten, and then repeat for another rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

To perform this exercise one arm at a time, if you were curling your right arm for example, you'd stand in front and slightly to the left of the cable so that you can curl your arm straight up with the cable pulling your arm directly back at a straight angle.

BIRD DOG

STEP 1: SETUP

Get onto all fours with your hands under your shoulders, knees under your hips, and head facing down at the ground in front of you. Your spine should be in a neutral position, with just a very slight arch.

STEP 2

Brace your core, and then without allowing any movement to occur at the low back, kick one of your legs backwards while simultaneously punching the opposite arm forward until they are both fully straightened. Hold this end position for a second or two, come back down to the starting position on all fours, and then repeat with the other arm and leg. Continue alternating until you finish the desired number of reps for each side. Take it slow and control every single rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

To better engage the core muscles, think about kicking the heel of your foot straight back and make a fist with your arm while contracting your arm muscles.
If you are unable to perform the arm and leg movement together, try the modified version with only your legs and then over time try to introduce the arms.
Once this becomes easier, you can hold the end position for longer, even up to 10 seconds.

DUMBBELL CHEST SUPPORTED ROW (MID/UPPER BACK FOCUSED)

STEP 1: SETUP

Set up an incline bench to an angle of about 30 degrees, typically the second notch up from the bottom. Grab a pair of dumbbells using a thumbless grip and lay your chest on the bench with your arms hanging down by your sides and palms facing each other. Plant the balls of your feet firmly into the ground with your legs fully straightened or slightly bent.

STEP 2

To stabilize your body, bring your shoulders down and away from your ears, squeeze your glutes and flex your abs. Then, pull your elbows back behind your body at about a 45 to 60 degree angle away from your torso. Squeeze your shoulder blades together at the top position.

STEP 3

Control the weight back down to the starting position instead of letting it just drop. Let your shoulder blades open up, reset, and then go into your next rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Think about pulling with your elbows each rep in order to better activate your back.

DUMBBELL LATERAL RAISES

STEP 1: SETUP

Grab a pair of dumbbells and stand with your feet about shoulder width apart and knees slightly bent. Lean your torso forward about 15 degrees.

STEP 2

Brace your core. While keeping your arms just slightly bent, raise your hands out in front of you. As you do so, raise your arms in a Y position in front of you. This is about 15 to 30 degrees in front of your body. Raise the weight until your arms reach shoulder-height, control them back down until your hands are down in front of your thighs, and then repeat for more reps.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

To better help with muscle activation, you can try using a thumbless grip and rather than thinking about raising the weight up, think about raising the weight out as if you were pushing your hands out towards the walls.

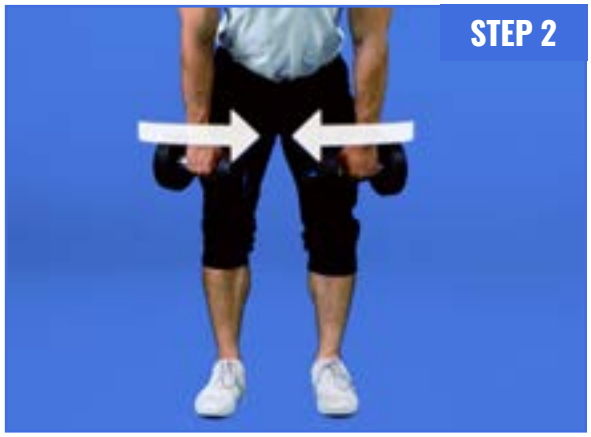
DUMBBELL ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

STEP 1: SETUP

Grab a pair of dumbbells, hold them by your sides, and take a shoulder-width stance with your feet pointed slightly outwards at about a 15 degree angle.

STEP 2

Contract your abs, take a deep breath in through your nose, then descend by pushing your hips straight back. Keep just a very slight bend at your knees and keep the bar as close to your body as possible, ideally right above the middle of your feet. As you descend, your hands should move from a neutral position at your sides to your palms facing towards you with the dumbbells held horizontally in front of your legs. Lower the dumbbells only until the point where you can't push your hips back without your lower back starting to round, usually at knee level or mid-shin level.



STEP 3

Keep your core braced and then exhale as you reverse the motion by pushing your hips forward and then rotating the dumbbells back into the starting position by your sides. Once your legs are fully straight, repeat for another rep. Spend about 2-3 seconds on slowly controlling the weight down, and then about 1 second to bring the weight back up.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

To better engage the hamstrings, you can think about pulling the floor back with your heels as you come up.

FRONT FOOT ELEVATED REVERSE LUNGES

STEP 1: SETUP

Grab a pair of dumbbells and stand with your feet together on a small elevated platform like a weight plate. Brace your core.

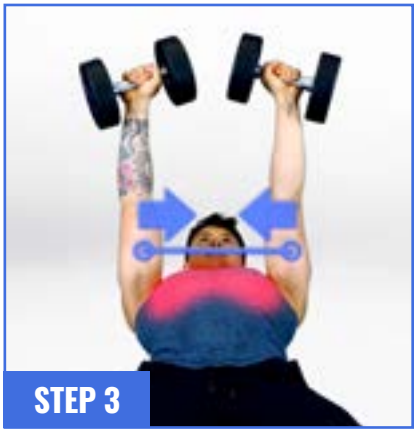
STEP 2

While keeping your front leg planted on the platform, take a long step backwards with your other leg and sink down into a lunge position by driving the knee of your back leg towards the ground. Keep your back neutral and lean your torso forward slightly by about 20 degrees to better engage the glutes. Continue descending until your back knee almost touches the ground. Pause briefly in this position, and then push through the heel of your front leg to drive your hips forward, raising your body up back into the starting position with your feet together. Take your next step back with the other leg and continue alternating until you finish the desired number of reps on each leg.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Avoid relying too much on your back leg to push your body up. Instead, after taking your step back, think of your back leg as a kickstand for balance and don't rely on it too much to kick yourself back up.

LOW INCLINE DUMBBELL PRESS



STEP 1: SETUP

Set up an incline bench to about 15 to 30 degrees, typically the first to second notch up from the bottom. Grab a pair of dumbbells and sit on the bench. Kick up the dumbbells one at a time to get them into position with your arms straight over your body. Pull your shoulder blades down away from your ears and pinch them together to create a small space between your lower back and the bench. Firmly plant your feet on the ground.

STEP 2

Brace your core and then control the weight down by dropping your elbows to about a 45 to 60 degree angle from your torso. Allow your hands to naturally turn in slightly. Continue lowering until the weights reach around the level of your chest, or as low as is comfortable for you.

STEP 3

Use your chest to push the weight back up until your arms are fully locked out and directly over your shoulders. Think about pulling your arms together as if you were trying to touch your biceps together to move the weight up.

PALLOFF PRESS

STEP 1: SETUP

Set the cable machine with a handle attachment to around the level of your chest. Position yourself sideways from the cable, grab the handle by interlocking both hands around it, and then take a few steps laterally away from it while keeping the handle at your chest. Maintain just a slight bend in your knees.

STEP 2

Brace your core, and then while keeping your body straight and hips facing forward, slowly extend your arms outward in front of you at the height of your chest. Continue until they're completely straight and then slowly bring your arms back to the starting position before continuing for another rep. Continue your reps on one side before facing the other way to work the other side.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

If you're using a band instead of a cable machine, you'll simply loop it around a stable fixture at this height. Once this becomes easy, you can choose to either increase the weight, step further away from the cable or band, and/or introduce a squat to the movement by bending your knees a little bit more as you perform it, and gradually getting to the point where you're able to do this in a full squat position.

PULL-UPS

STEP 1: SETUP

Grip the bar using an overhand grip slightly wider than shoulder-width apart. From here, let your body hang and then begin stabilizing your body by bringing your feet together, flexing your quads and glutes and contracting your abs. You want to maintain this position as you pull.

STEP 2

Initiate the pull by first bringing your shoulders down and away from your ears. Then, pull your elbows down and back into your sides as if you were trying to pull them into your back pockets. As you do this, think about trying to bring your chest up towards the bar. Continue pulling-up until your chin is above the bar. From here, control yourself by letting your elbows move up and out until your arms are almost fully straightened, and then continue into your next rep.

SEATED CABLE ROW (MID/UPPER BACK FOCUSED)

STEP 1: SETUP

Once you've found the attachment, get into the starting position with your knees slightly bent on the pad and back straight.

STEP 2

Brace your core and bring your shoulders down and away from your ears. Pull your elbows back behind your body at about a 45 to 60 degree angle away while squeezing your shoulder blades together.

STEP 3

Control the weight back down to the starting position, letting your shoulder blades open up, and then go into your next rep. You can let your upper body round forward to fully open up your back, as long as your core remains tight and your lower back doesn't round excessively.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

You can use the V-bar attachment, but a better option would be a wider handle setup so that your elbows can flare outwards as you pull. If you don't have access to any of that, you can try putting two handles over a lat pulldown attachment and twist them to lock them in place.

SEATED LEG CURLS

STEP 1: SETUP

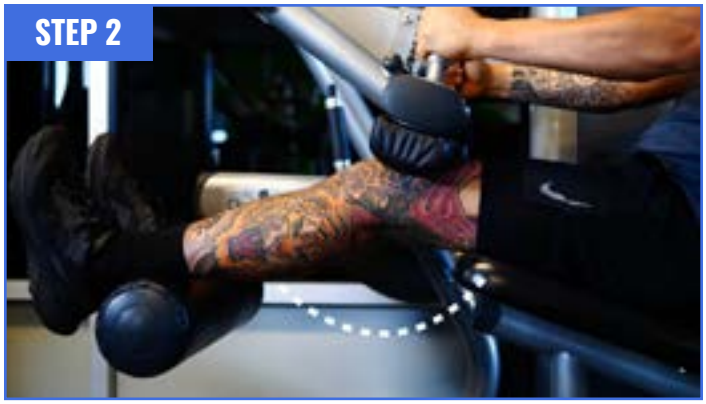
Set up your back rest so that when you sit down, your knees are aligned directly beside the pivot point of the machine. For most people, your knees should end up just past the edge of the seat. Next, adjust the height of your foot pad so that when you're seated, your legs are in just a slightly bent position. The pad should also be resting just above the back of your heels.

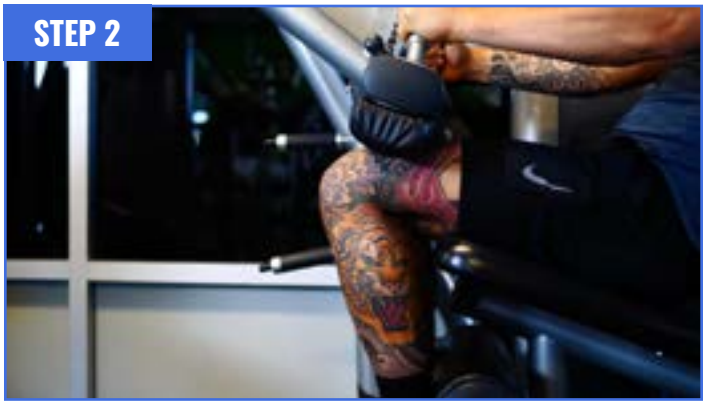
STEP 2

Grab the handles on the side of the machine and pull up on them by engaging your lats. Brace your core, and then while keeping your toes pointed straight up, pull the weight as far down as you can using your hamstrings. Slowly control the weight back close to the starting position with your legs almost fully extended, and then repeat for another rep.

ADDITIONAL TIP

Avoid fully extending your legs at the top position. The first 15 degrees or so of the movement actually involves more of the calves, so cut the range of motion short slightly by stopping each rep a little before your legs are completely straightened at the top position.





SEATED LEG EXTENSIONS

STEP 1: SETUP

Set up your back rest so that when you sit down, your knees are aligned directly beside the pivot point of the machine. For most people, your knees should end up just past the edge of the seat. Next, adjust the height of your foot pad so that when you're seated, your legs are at a roughly 90 degree angle with the pad resting just above your ankle.

STEP 2

Grab the handles on the side of the machine and pull up on them by engaging your lats. Brace your core, and then while keeping your toes pointed straight up, use your quads to extend your legs straight forward. As you do so, keep your knees facing forward rather than rotating them in or outwards. Extend as far up as you can, pause briefly at the top, and then control the weight all the way back down to the starting position and repeat.

SEATED MID-CHEST CABLE FLYES

STEP 1: SETUP

Move an adjustable bench over to the middle of a cable machine, positioned a couple of feet in front of it. Set the incline to one notch down from the highest position to about a 75 degree angle. Adjust the height of the cables around the level of your mid-chest. Grab each handle, sit on the bench, and get your arms into the starting position with your arms out to your sides and elbows bent. At this point your forearms should be lined up directly with the cable.

Pull your shoulder blades down and back together. Plant your feet firmly on the ground.

STEP 2

Use your chest to bring your arms together with your arms straight in front of you. Think about squeezing your biceps in as if you were trying to bring them together to better engage your chest. Pause at the end position briefly, slowly control the weight back while bending your arms until your elbows reach the level of your torso, and then repeat for another rep.

SEATED WEIGHTED CALF RAISES

STEP 1: SETUP

Sit on a flat bench and elevate your toes onto a pair of weight plates in front of you set at about hip width apart. You ideally want about a 3-6 inch elevation. Grab a pair of dumbbells and hold them on your thighs. At this point your knees should be bent to 90 degrees with your toes on the edge of the platform and heels resting on the ground.

STEP 2

While keeping your toes on the platform, push straight up onto your toes as far as you can, keeping most of the pressure on your big toe. Control your heel slowly back down to the bottom position and then repeat.

STANDING BARBELL OVERHEAD PRESS

STEP 1: SETUP

Set up the bar in a rack such that it's at the level of your armpits. Get under the bar and grab it with a grip just outside shoulder-width apart. Tuck your elbows so that they align directly under the bar with your forearms vertical. Lift the bar up off the rack, take 3 steps back, and plant your feet about shoulder width apart with your toes slightly pointed outwards.

STEP 2

Squeeze your glutes, flex your quads, and brace your core. Take a deep breath in through your nose and then exhale as you press the bar straight up. As you do so, slightly tilt your chin back to avoid hitting it. Once the bar passes your head, you can tilt your head back forward back into its neutral position. Press until your arms are straight.

STEP 3

Inhale as you lower the bar by dropping your elbows into a roughly 45 degree angle in front of your body until the bar reaches the level of your upper chest. Pause here briefly, re-stabilize your glutes and core if needed, and then continue for your next rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Avoid bending your knees and using leg drive to move the weight up. This is a different exercise. Instead, keep this a strict press by only using your upper body to press the weight up.

STANDING FACE PULLS

STEP 1: SETUP

Move a cable to the top position. Using a double rope attachment, grab the rope in each hand with a neutral grip. Next, set the weight light and take a few steps back away from the pulley. From here, raise your arms so that they are straight and directly facing the pulley.

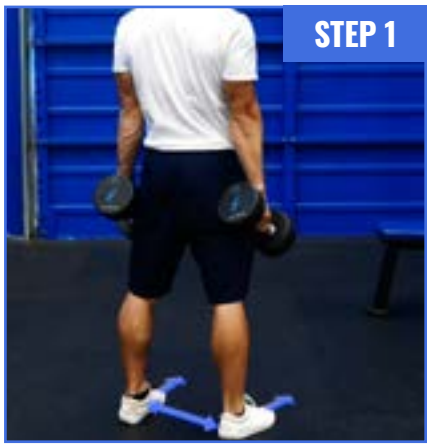
STEP 2

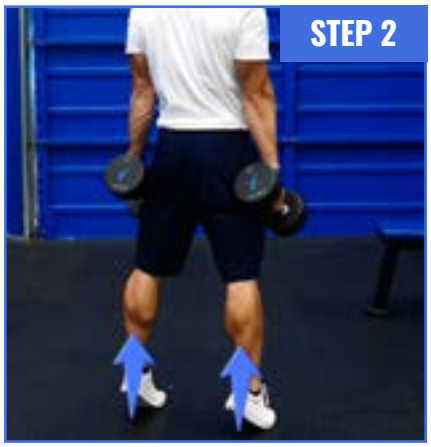
Brace your core and squeeze your glutes. Pull your hands towards your face, trying to get the cable to the level of your forehead. As you do so, pull back with both your elbows and hands, such that at the end position your arms are positioned in a "biceps flexing" pose at a 90 degree angle with your hands directly over your elbows. From here, slowly raise your arms up into a Y position and then back down. Then, straighten your arms back to the starting position.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

If using a band, you would execute this the exact same way, and simply use a wide overhand grip on the band. The band will be quite challenging from even just a few steps away, so position yourself relatively closer to the band where there isn't as much tension.

STANDING WEIGHTED CALF RAISES (BARBELL OR DUMBBELL)





STEP 1: SETUP

You can perform this movement either using a weighted barbell or with a pair of dumbbells in each hand. Grab a pair of dumbbells and place your feet about hip width apart facing forwards.

STEP 2

Brace your core and then push straight up onto your toes as far as you can, keeping most of the pressure on your big toes. Then, control your heel slowly back down until they touch the ground, and repeat. Once you get good at this, you can progress it by adding a small 5 or 10 lb weight plate under each of your toes and perform it on there. Once you get good at that, you can use a larger weight plate or an elevated platform for a greater range of motion. It can be hard to balance so just be cautious when performing this so you don't fall over. The same also applies if you were using barbells.

BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES

UPPER BODY 1

EXERCISE	EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES	WATCH ON YOUTUBE
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	Pec-Deck Machine Fly (plus half reps)	https://youtu.be/rnV3y1P7894
	Dumbbell Fly	https://youtu.be/WRn2hqy0gXU
Pull-Ups	(Weighted) Chin-Ups	https://youtu.be/-TZRdvUS7Qo
	Banded Pull-Ups	https://youtu.be/VGm-f5-T5no
	Inverted Row	https://youtu.be/SyMSay4zrsA
	Pull-Up Negatives	https://youtu.be/SyMSay4zrsA
	Kneeling Lat Pulldowns	https://youtu.be/4LxKeTqlpZA
	Lat Pulldowns	https://youtu.be/AvYZZhEI7Xk
Dumbbell Lateral Raises	Cable Lateral Raise	https://youtu.be/1muit9qEctY
	Lying Incline Lateral Raise	https://youtu.be/upEqeI0F73M
	Lean In Lateral Raise	https://youtu.be/2q4kjTDg-vs
	Wide Grip Barbell Upright Row (last resort)	https://youtu.be/6BTMVh9AnCw
Dumbbell Chest Supported Row (mid/upper back focused)	Barbell Row (mid/upper back focused)	https://youtu.be/FTCmwlfZ29A
	Seated Cable Row (mid/ upper back focused)	https://youtu.be/Q-5V5T55giY
	Chest Supported Machine Row	https://youtu.be/iDiVxqvHGWY

UPPER BODY 2

EXERCISE	EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES	WATCH ON YOUTUBE
Seated Mid-Chest Cable Fly	Pec-Deck Machine Fly (plus half reps)	https://youtu.be/rnV3y1P7894
	Dumbbell Fly	https://youtu.be/WRn2hqy0gXU
Seated Cable Row (mid/ upper back focused)	Barbell Row (mid/upper back focused)	https://youtu.be/FTCmwlfZ29A
	Dumbbell Chest Supported Row (mid/upper back focused)	https://youtu.be/kNvy2_9Ji2w
	Chest Supported Machine Row	https://youtu.be/iDiVxqvHGWY
Standing Barbell Overhead Press	Standing Dumbbell Shoulder Press	https://youtu.be/jWriqmLrQqs
	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press	https://youtu.be/DPXG3BJvl8A
	Seated Neutral-Grip Dumbbell Shoulder Press (*shoulder friendly)	https://youtu.be/W35eREjZnhI
	Half Kneeling Landmine Press (*shoulder friendly)	https://youtu.be/JOOS3MPCT8s
Behind Body Cable Curls	Incline Dumbbell Curls	https://youtu.be/3D56VDVkQnM
	Barbell Curl	https://youtu.be/-ClfZ00zo8c
Standing Face Pulls	Bent Over Dumbbell Face Pulls	https://youtu.be/kA415Unr-_E
	(Weighted) Prone Arm Circles	https://youtu.be/6D-4V_M8RJA
	Wall Slides	https://youtu.be/x4zjfuLXHVk

LOWER BODY 1

EXERCISE	EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES	WATCH ON YOUTUBE
Barbell Back Squat	Quad-Focused Leg Press	https://youtu.be/0nrW-q7-WRQ
	Smith Machine Squat	https://youtu.be/zSVi51Jp3el
	Barbell Back Box Squat (*knee friendly)	https://youtu.be/QryQO4VuPK8
	Weighted Step-Ups (*knee friendly)	https://youtu.be/Cjc3AgmdtIA
	Dumbbell Goblet Squat (*lower back friendly)	https://youtu.be/nYDEYFXN2Rs
	Bulgarian Split Squat (quad-focused)	https://youtu.be/r9XtxWSTlcg
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	Barbell Romanian Deadlift	https://youtu.be/Q-2telZDPRw
	Hyperextensions (back/ hamstring focused)	https://youtu.be/RU5d2H_OmSc
Seated Leg Extensions	Sissy Squat	https://youtu.be/3SeCC8ABZ_Q
	Heel Elevated Goblet Squat	https://youtu.be/I9crMLuT4II
	Reverse Lunges (*knee friendly)	https://youtu.be/AUEGDvCrQJA
Standing Weighted Calf Raises (barbell or dumbbell)	Toes-Elevated Smith Machine Calf Raises	https://youtu.be/_ChZv2iluM8
	Single Leg Weighted Calf Raise	https://youtu.be/cRKA_Qdut7I
	Leg Press Calf Raises	https://youtu.be/s8yUXsZrgE0
Palloff Press	RKC Plank	https://youtu.be/lOgA1UfFbWY
	Bird Dog	https://youtu.be/4qE_9h_6Hes
	Side Plank	https://youtu.be/o4LGPtKjbhU
	Dead Bug	https://youtu.be/UJ7b8gYa2Es

LOWER BODY 2

EXERCISE	EXERCISE ALTERNATIVES	WATCH ON YOUTUBE
Barbell Deadlift	Sumo Deadlift (*lower back friendly)	https://youtu.be/9rXKd-_DaRs
	Trap Bar Deadlift (*lower back friendly)	https://youtu.be/5mnlJtf-7WM
	Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift	https://youtu.be/Xu4DxwKWzI4
	Hyperextensions (back/ hamstring focused)	https://youtu.be/RU5d2H_OmSc
	Glute Focused Leg Press	https://youtu.be/p13BNdwR93A
Front Foot Elevated Reverse Lunges	Reverse Lunges (*knee friendly)	https://youtu.be/AUEGDvCrQJA
	Weighted Step Ups (*knee friendly)	https://youtu.be/Cjc3AgmdtIA
	Single-Leg Leg Press	https://youtu.be/hdioTTf8qdw
	Bulgarian Split Squat (glute focused)	https://youtu.be/sqadB2rroz0
Seated Leg Curls	Swiss Ball Leg Curls	https://youtu.be/uRBpd65dbYs
	Dumbbell Lying Leg Curls	https://youtu.be/Ot1MZipNLOQ
Seated Weighted Calf Raise	Seated Bodyweight Calf Raises	https://youtu.be/jW-cNnwRJ7E
Bird Dog	RKC Plank	https://youtu.be/lOgA1UfFbWY
	Side Plank	https://youtu.be/o4LGPtKjbhU
	Palloff Press	https://youtu.be/WhCH2CwVo4I
	Dead Bug	https://youtu.be/UJ7b8gYa2Es

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS

I HOPE THIS PDF IS USEFUL FOR YOU!

I put in a lot of effort into providing this routine for you free of charge. All I ask in return is that you show your support for my work and connecting with me on my social media platforms where I share more informative content on a regular basis:

WEBSITE	BUILTWITHSCIENCE.COM
INSTAGRAM	@JEREMYETHIER
YOUTUBE	YOUTUBE.COM/JEREMYETHIER
TIKTOK	TIKTOK.COM/@JEREMYETHIER
FACEBOOK	@JEREMYETHIERFIT

ENJOY!

DISCLAIMER

The content provided in this PDF is for informational and educational purposes only. Jeremy Ethier is not a medical doctor, psychologist, therapist, nutritionist, or registered dietitian. The contents of this document should not be construed as medical, psychological, dietary, nutritional, or healthcare advice of any kind. The contents of this document are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any health conditions, nor are they intended to replace a physician, dietitian, nutritionist, or other qualified healthcare professional's advice. You should always consult your physician, dietitian, or other qualified healthcare professional on any matters regarding your health, engagement in physical activity, and/or diet before starting any fitness program or meal plan to determine if it is suitable for your needs. This is especially important if you (or your family members) have a history of high blood pressure or heart disease, if you have ever experienced chest pain while exercising, or if you have experienced chest pain in the past month when not engaged in physical activity. You should also consult your physician, dietitian, or other qualified healthcare professional before starting any fitness program, meal plan, or dietary regimen if you smoke, have high cholesterol, are obese, or have a bone or joint problem that could be made worse by a change in physical activity or diet. Do not start or continue any fitness program, meal plan, or dietary regimen if your physician, dietitian, or health care provider advises against it. If you experience faintness, dizziness, pain, shortness of breath or any other form of discomfort at any time while exercising or while following any meal plan/dietary regimen, you should stop immediately. If you are in Canada and think you are having a medical or health emergency, call your health care provider, or 911, immediately.

Please note the following:

- any and all exercise that you do as a result of what you read in this PDF shall be performed **solely at your own risk**;
- any and all meal plans that you follow or adhere to as a result of what you read in this PDF shall be used **solely at your own risk**; and
- any and all foods or beverages that you consume as a result of what you read in this PDF shall be consumed **solely at your own risk**.

No part of this report may be reproduced or transmitted in any form whatsoever, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording, or by any informational storage or retrieval system without the express written, dated, and signed permission from the author (Jeremy Ethier). All copyrights are reserved.
Built With Science™ may not be copied or used for any purpose without express written consent.